

Curriculum Vitae (CV) – AJAY KAKRA

1. **Name of the firm:** Forvis Mazars LLP
2. **Name of Staff:** Ajay Kakra
3. **Date of Birth:** 25/06/1976
4. **Nationality:** Indian

5. Education

Institute	Degree	Year
National Institute for Agricultural Extension Management (MANAGE), Hyderabad	Post Graduate in Agri Business Management (PGDABM)	2001
Rajasthan Agriculture University (RAU), Bikaner, Rajasthan	B.Sc. (Agriculture)	1999

6. Membership in Professional Associations:

Member of the Agriculture Committee for North India, Confederation of Indian Industries (CII)

7. Other Trainings:

- Introductory Program on Banking from Institute for Financial Management and Research (IFMR), Chennai
- Agricultural Entrepreneurship training from Ministry of Agriculture, Israel

8. Countries of Work Experience:

India, Bangladesh, Nepal, Sri Lanka, Bhutan, Ethiopia, Tanzania, Malawi, Ghana, Rwanda, Zambia and Kenya

9. Languages (Good/Fair/Poor)

	To Speak	To Read	To Write
English	Good	Good	Good
Hindi	Good	Good	Good
Punjabi	Good	Fair	Fair

10. Employment Record:

Period		Employer	Position held
From	To		
Nov-24	Till date	Forvis Mazars LLP	Partner, Food and Agriculture
May-22	Oct-24	JU Agrisciences Pvt Ltd	Managing Partner
May-11	Apr-22	PricewaterhouseCoopers Private Limited	Practice Leader & Director, Agriculture & Natural Resources (ANR)
Sep-06	May-11	Yes Bank Ltd	Sr. Vice President (Food & Agribusiness Strategic Advisory & Research)
Jul-04	Sep-06	ICICI Bank Ltd	Product Manager
Apr-02	Jul-04	Wockhardt Limited	Area Sales Manager
Jun-01	Feb-02	Maharashtra Hybrid Seed Company (Mahyco) Limited	Management trainee

11. Work Undertaken that Best Illustrates Capability to Handle the Tasks Assigned

Project Name: Transactional Advisor for selection of bidders through RFP under Department of Horticulture, Haryana, Funded by JICA

Year: June 2025 - Ongoing

Location: Haryana, India

Client: Department of Horticulture, Govt of Haryana, Funded by Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA)

Main project features: Transaction Advisory Department of Horticulture, Govt of Haryana

The Govt. of Haryana has approved the project entitled The Project for Promoting Sustainable Horticulture in Haryana on 03.11.2023 with a vision to strengthen the horticulture supply chain. The major crops/commodities on which the project will be focusing are Tomato, Potato, Onion, Kinnow, Carrot, Guava, Peas, Garlic, Capsicum, Ginger, Peach, Strawberry, Okra, Honey & Mushroom. Forvis Mazars has selected as transactional Advisor for selection of bidders through RFP under Department of Horticulture.

Position held: Project Advisor

Main activities include:

- Preparation of RFP document: Mazars shall prepare the Request for Proposal (RFP) document as per the requirement of JICA Project, Haryana.
- Evaluation of Technical & Financial bids: Mazars shall prepare the evaluation document of the technical & financial bids of RFP received from bidders and assist department for allocation of scores and finalization of consulting firm including addressing the queries raised from different parties during bid evaluation.
- Contract document preparation: Mazars shall assist the department in preparation of contract document and contract signing which shall be signed between Department of Horticulture and selected consulting firm for work of PMC.
- Presentation and rectification

Project Name: SMART, Maharashtra

Year: April 2022 - Ongoing

Location: Pune, Maharashtra

Client: Government of Maharashtra and World Bank

Main project features: Monitoring and Evaluation of SMART project

The SMART project is implemented by the government of Maharashtra for creation of agribusiness linkages for entrepreneurs. For monitoring all the activities, the World Bank under the SMART project has stipulated the appointment of M&E agency. PwC was appointed as M&E agency for the project.

Position held: Signing Partner

Activities performed:

- Structuring and finalizing the sampling methodology with project and their economists
- Oversight of M&E structure and framework
- Resource deployment, utilization
- Managing the timelines for execution
- Overview of baseline survey and mid term evaluation surveys
- Presentation of findings to client
- Reporting of observations

Project Name: Abu Dhabi Farmer Service Center (ADFSC)

Year: April 2018 - Ongoing

Location: United Arab Emirates (UAE)

Client: ADFSC/ UAE Government

Main project features: The ADFSC hired the service of PwC UAE and PwC India to undertake the organizational evaluation and restructuring study

ADFSC wanted to revamp its organizational structure and operations to increase efficiency of the organization. Also the objective was to boost the domestic supply chain of F&V for import substitution and establish greater market linkages with private players.

Position held: Agribusiness Expert, Organization Development Expert

Activities performed:

- Assessment of each function of the organization (HR, procurement, storage & Handling, distribution, primary processing and value addition, commercial division, admin & accounts, IT etc)
- Mapping of existing process, procedures and policies
- Identification of gaps in operational and process areas
- Benchmarking with global best practices
- Suggesting overall vision, strategy and operational guideline for an efficient functioning of ADFSC
- Coordinating internal workshops with each unit head and division head of ADFSC for approval of new suggested process, policies and procedures.

Project Name: Himachal Pradesh Horticulture Development Project (HPHDP)

Year: April 2018 - Ongoing

Location: Himachal Pradesh, India

Client: World Bank/ HP Government

Main project features: The WBG/HP Government hired the service of PwC to manage and operate the Agribusiness Promotion Facility (ABPF) under the HPHDP project

The overall objective of this Assignment is to develop entrepreneurs in the state of HP, India. Provide support facilitation in key areas such as business identification, business planning activities, technology support, access to finance, mentorship for starting up new businesses.

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed:

Main activities include:

- Identification of key value chains and entrepreneurship opportunities across the state.
- Market assessment of these opportunities and estimation of the competitiveness of these opportunities in the broader context of existing competition and domestic as well as international markets
- Undertake investment workshops across the state to create awareness of the ABPF facility and the support it can provide
- Examining the opportunities and develop a framework for convergence with existing central and state sponsored schemes.
- Work in tandem with the formal financing systems (mainly the banks) to understand the key financial instruments for entrepreneurs/ SME's and work out modalities of supporting them through the Matching Grant under the ABPF component
- Developing modalities, structure, operational guideline for the Matching Grant Scheme under the ABPF component. Approval from World Bank and operationalizing the same
- Technology scouting for identification of relevant technologies for entrepreneurs from HP. Undertaking collaboration with leading technology institutes in India and abroad for technology transfer/ training and capacity development
- Supporting the entrepreneurs in financing of projects. Also supporting them to run through the Matching grant process to secure funding for the project.
- Identification of mentors for new entrepreneurs. Facilitating mentor-mentee workshops to impart one to one opportunity for mentorship in areas of marketing, business operations, management of new ventures and other related area

Project Name: Index Insurance Feasibility Study – Agriculture Value Chain Mapping, Mozambique

Year: Nov 2017 - Ongoing

Location: Mozambique

Client: IFC

Main project features: The WBG hired the service of PwC to conduct Value Chain Mapping of agricultural commodities in Mozambique with the objective of identifying promising index insurance opportunities for the Bank.

The overall objective of this Assignment is to investigate the potential of bundling index insurance products with 3-4 agricultural commodity value chains to be discussed and agreed with the World Bank Group (WBG) and Ministério da Terra, Ambiente e Desenvolvimento Rural (MITADER) teams managing the Mozambique Agriculture and Natural Resources Landscape Management Project.

Position held: Project Director

Activities performed:

Main activities include:

- Working with the WBG and MITADER project team members to agree 3-4 value chains that should be considered for bundling with index insurance products.
 - Identifying different farmer and distributor segments within each value chain and evaluating the value of insurance and the ability of each cohort to pay the required premium.
 - Collecting information on premium rates considered affordable and sustainable for each identified market segment.
 - Performing a detailed analysis of current and projected farmer level net profit margins with and without insurance and clearly highlighting fundamental assumptions underlying the profit margin analysis
 - Documenting the value proposition for bundling insurance with their current and planned bouquet of services for each identified distributor segment in the value chain
 - Provide realistic estimates of farmer numbers for each identified market segment and for the whole market
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Project Name: Coalition for African Rice Development (CARD)-Final Review Assessment

Year: May 2017 - Ongoing

Location: 23 Sub Saharan African Countries

Client: JICA (Japan International Co-operation Agency)

Main project features: PwC Japan, in partnership with PwC India, is running a project for JICA (Japan International Co-operation Agency). The project's main scope is to perform final review assessment of an initiative CARD (Coalition for African Rice Development) for the support of self-help efforts of national governments to expand rice production in Africa. CARD is a multi-country (23 countries in Sub-Saharan Africa) and multi institutional effort to double rice production in the target countries over a period of 10 years. In addition to JICA, the Steering Committee consists of 11 institutions: the Japan International Research Center for Agricultural Sciences (JIRCAS), AGRA, The Forum for Agricultural Research in Africa (FARA), the International Rice Research Institute (IRRI), AfricaRice, the New Partnership for Africa's Development (NEPAD), the Food and Agricultural Organization (FAO), African Development Bank (AfDB), the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD), and the World Bank (WB).

Position held: Agriculture Expert

Activities performed:

The deliverables of the assignment will be evaluate the achievements, lessons-learnt, issues and key success factors of CARD as an international initiative and at national levels'. Based on the findings, the project team will need to formulate development plan beyond 2019 for CARD in the field of rice production in Africa.

Project Name: ADB funded Enhancing Competitiveness and capacity of SMEs in four targeted clusters in Sri Lanka

Year: July 2016 – Ongoing

Location: Sri Lanka

Client: Asian Development Bank

Main project features:

The objective of the assignment is to increasing the competitive of the SMEs in four industry clusters that have the potential to increase Sri Lanka's exports. These four industries includes fruit and vegetable, processed food and beverage, rubber and ICT/BPO.

Position held: Team Leader for F&V and F&B sector

Activities Performed: The activities carried out by Ajay includes:

- a. Conduct industry analysis of fruit and vegetable, processed food and beverage from the perspective of SME participation. Based on the analysis identify 2-3 potential products/services based on the cluster data – through both demand and supply side surveys
- b. Conducting an in-depth gender responsive value chain analysis of the identified 2-3 products/services across fruit and vegetable, processed food and beverage
- c. Assess the bankability of the identified value chains in order to make it feasible for all key stakeholders SMEs, Exporters and Importers

- d. Developing a strategy for cluster development, expanding and strengthening women entrepreneurship and financing and helping them move up to the value chain
- e. Establish robust SME linkages with large exporters and industry bodies
- f. Structure and Prepare cluster based loan of the 8-10 value chains/clusters identified (combining all four sectors),
- g. Support these clusters in establishing the special purpose vehicle or other collaboration that will borrow on behalf of SMEs in the cluster
- h. Training 500 existing and potential SMEs (especially Women Entrepreneurs) on business development services and management including trainings on financial literacy
- i. Support Export Development Board (EDB) in branding Sri Lanka as ICT/BPO Destination and building capacity of the small startups to move up the value chain

Project Name: Preparation of Techno-economic feasibility report and Detailed Project Report for Integrated Poultry Unit

Year: Nov 2016 – Ongoing

Location: Gabon

Client: Leading Poultry Processor

Main project features:

The objective of the assignment is to develop a Techno-economic Feasibility report and Detailed Project Report for setting up the integrated poultry project. The feasibility report and DPR was to be used by the client for raising debt and equity for the project.

Position held: Team Leader

Activities Performed: The activities carried out by Ajay includes:

1. Phase 1: Preparation and Finalization of Feasibility Study

- a) Assess the location of the project and evaluate whether the proposed location is suitable for maize cultivation and establishing an integrated poultry project in the country.
- b) Assess the agro-climatic conditions of the proposed location to substantiate the suitability establishing integrated poultry project at the proposed location.
- c) Analyse the current status of the maize production, poultry feed, eggs production, poultry meat production, As-Is analysis of hatcheries in the country.
- d) Assess the overall value chain of poultry and identify the key business opportunities present at different levels of value chain.
- e) Carry out the assessment of the existing market for the poultry and products in the country along with export markets.
- f) Prepare a preliminary financial model showing the pilot project cost, operation costs and returns.
- g) Conduct a technical assessment for the project requirements including assessment the technical feasibility of the proposed integrated poultry project.
- h) Identify the constraints and risks associated with establishing an integrated poultry project in the country along with risk mitigating measures.
- i) Assess the current incentives and perks offered by the Government to support poultry sector in the country.

2. Phase 2: Preparation of a detailed project report:

- a) Identify optimum timing and phasing of the construction of buildings and roll-out of equipment's.
- b) Development of a detailed procurement strategy for the integrated poultry unit
- c) Development of a comprehensive marketing strategy for brooders, broilers, eggs, feed and other poultry products.
- d) Preparation of the base case of project cost estimates
- e) Develop cost recovery options (and alternative revenue generation) to ensure that the project is sustainable
- f) Conduct economic and financial analysis for the project.

Project Name: Shire Valley Irrigation Project

Year: July 2016 – Ongoing

Location: Malawi

Client: World Bank & African Development Bank (AfDB)

Main project features:

The Government of Malawi intends to develop irrigated agriculture in the Lower Shire Valley (on the west (right) bank of the Shire River) within the administrative districts of Chikhwawa and Nsanje. It requested financial assistance from the World Bank (WB) and the African Development Bank (AfDB) for the preparation of proposed Shire Valley Irrigation Project (SVIP).

The current assignment is to develop a sound and realistic agricultural development planning strategy that will lead to real value addition in agricultural production with respect to the costs of the irrigation investment. The study should include analysis of different options of innovative market-oriented and private-led agricultural production systems where smallholder farmers will be promoted as small-scale agro-entrepreneurs. The underlying objective is to encourage a change of mindset so that smallholder farmers from the very beginning move out of from rain-fed and maize-based subsistence farming system and enter into commercial oriented production mode.

Position held: Value Chain Expert

Activities Performed: As an value chain Expert, carried out following activities:

1. Agronomic diagnostic and market opportunity analysis

- Identification of the potential agricultural production and proposal of a credible development strategy which included review of existing agricultural market and supply chain analyses to determine the most promising and viable market opportunities locally (urban markets, local agro-processing industry, etc.) , regionally (neighbouring countries and South Africa) and internationally (EU and Asian markets in particular)

2. Consultation with agri-business private investors:

- Gauge potential interest for agribusiness/agriculture-related investments in SVIP from various reputable national, regional and international investors;
- Conduct targeted interviews to assess the interest of potential investors and to understand their requirements and pre-conditions for investing in the SVIP area, in terms of agronomy, land tenure, credit, business environment, market, incentives etc.
- Review existing agri-business models linking the smallholder farmers to large scale agro-based companies/organizations in order to fully exploit the domestic and international markets of agricultural produce and come up with the best options for SVIP.

Project Name: Strategic Grain Reserve, Malawi

Year: Oct 2015 – Ongoing

Location: Malawi

Client: Ministry of Agriculture Irrigation and Water Development Malawi

Main project features:

Until recently (past two years) Malawi has been experiencing growing food insecurity problems and only recently this trend is being reversed. The country in the recent past relied on food imports and food aid. Currently about 10% of Malawians are chronically food insecure and are in need of long-term safety nets to sustain their livelihoods.

Natural disasters, such as drought, floods and crop destruction by pests, have also had adverse effects on the country's national food supply situation. The Strategic Grain Reserve was created to provide a source of emergency food relief and to ensure that the country has access to adequate supplies of food at all times to meet subsistence and commercial needs.

The government has decided to hire external consultant to streamline the design, operations and management of the SGR in order to ensure smooth delivery mechanism for emergency food relief to the poorest of the poor population.

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed-Part of the following activities:

Assessment of Strategic Grain Reserve considering but not limited to the following:

- (a) Examining and reviewing the SGR procedures (tendering for purchases and sales, management of the stocks, pricing, etc.)
- (b) Ensuring that procedures are adhered to and are in accordance with the Trust Deed of NFRA
- (c) Determining the optimum stock level of the SGR (including the financial reserve)
- (d) Establishing options for the capitalization of NFRA
- (e) Reviewing the possible role of NFRA in price stabilization
- (f) Determining the storage requirement SGR including management of the facilities
- (g) Making recommendations on the management of maize market, in relation to the requirement of the SGR, and the needs of the retail market
- (h) Assessing the bottlenecks in the free flow of maize and making recommendations to resolve them
- (i) Facilitating private sector participation in meeting the needs of the maize market in Malawi
- (j) Initiating and reviewing studies on the functioning of the maize market

Project Name: Evaluation of the Pilot Project on Promoting **Financial Inclusion** by Electronic Distribution of Financial Services in Ethiopia

Year: October 2014 – Feb 2015

Location: Ethiopia

Client: United Nation Development Program (UNDP), Ethiopia

Main project features:

The objective of the evaluation is to assess the extent to which the objectives and expected outcomes of the pilot project has been achieved and identify areas of improvement which could produce better results. The most crucial part of the assessment is to present the key lessons learnt while implementation of the pilot project and provide recommendations that will provide a base for the future direction and strategy on electronic distribution of financial service in Ethiopia.

Overall evaluation needs to cover the whole project cycle, stating from design of the project to the impact on target beneficiaries, covering both the technical and financial aspects of the programme. The scope includes analysis and evaluation of the financial models and innovative technologies introduced to improve cash transfers to the beneficiaries of the PSNP project and to present key recommendations to make the programme implementation more effective and efficient in future.

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed-Part of the following activities:

- Studied various reports on financial inclusion and its status in Ethiopia
- Studied various reports on Ethiopian Financial Inclusion Project (EFIP) detailing its design, stakeholders, processes etc.
- Studied various initiatives undertaken in project region like PSNP program, HABP program
- Mapping of the roles and responsibilities of different stakeholders of the PSNP program

Project Name: Preparation of **Financial Inclusion** status report of the project titled “Governance and Accelerated Livelihood Security (GOALS)

Year: December 2013 – May 2014

Location: Orissa, Bihar, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh

Client: United Nation Development Program (UNDP), India

Main project features:

The objective of the study is to analyse the current status of financial inclusion in project districts. The proposed study will be based on secondary sources – RBI reports, project reports, process documents and primary data based on stakeholder consultation. The status report would be used to devise interventions that would improve the access and use of financial services by financially excluded section of the society and thus improve the livelihood of them

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed-Part of the following activities:

- Assessment of financial inclusion status in the selected areas
- Stakeholder meetings
- Identification of key gaps in the financial inclusion of various segments
- Assessment of financial services (current and potential) for the area
- Understanding key issues and challenges faced in the financial inclusion part
- Identifying key areas for **development of financial inclusion strategy**

Project Name: Preparation of market feasibility study of Non Timber Forest Produce (NTFP)

Year: December 2013 – July 2014

Location: Orissa, Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh

Client: United Nation Development Program (UNDP), India

Main project features:

The objective of the study is to create a knowledge product which can be used to support the development of **integrated, pro-poor, and environmentally sustainable “green” value chains** for NTFPs in the project districts.

At commodity level the study is looking to get an in-depth understanding of the dynamics of functioning of NTFP market. This would involve an inward looking review of the NTFP value chains, their actors and role, their behavior and competitions, their interdependencies and how they shape value creation and income generation. On the regional level focus of the study is to identify and understand the external factors that support or hinder development of the NTFP commodity value chains and influence the environment in which these value chains perform

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed-Part of the following activities:

- **Value chain study** for existing NTFP, development of evaluation matrix for them

- Stakeholder consultation
- Development of a status report for NTFP potential in the state and adopted districts

Project Name: SEDF II Program Completion Evaluation (PCE)

Year: October 2013 - Ongoing

Location: Bangladesh and Nepal, NE India, Bhutan

Client: International Finance Corporation (IFC)

Main project features:

The key objective of this assignment was to conduct an evaluation of SEDF –II program covering four geographies including Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan and North East India. As a part of this exercise, PwC is responsible for the evaluation of the Outputs, Outcomes and impact of SEDF II Schemes and Programs for MSMEs and Financial Institutions. The project is **aimed at improving the business environment for SMEs** by removing regulatory constraints, increasing access to finance, increasing the availability of business development services, creating sector-specific opportunities for SME growth and facilitating investment promotion in select geographies.

Position held: Access to Finance Specialist

Activities performed-Part of the following activities:

- Preparation of Evaluation Framework
- Desk review of the program documents including strategy, organization and management, operations, and project activities under consideration among others
- Evaluation of the Programs – The three interventions being evaluated include:
 - Access to Finance (A2F) – In-Depth interviews with Partner Financial Institutions (PFIs), with focus on validation of outputs and outcomes, and potential impacts of interventions on the immediate beneficiaries.
 - **Sustainable Business Advisory (SBA)** – In-Depth interviews with beneficiary SME's, service providers and other stakeholders to assess the impact of the program in terms of reach, effectiveness, efficiency and sustainability.
 - Investment Climate: In-depth interviews with the key stakeholders including private sector, trade associations and government counterparts to assess the impact on investment and licensing regime in Nepal and Bhutan respectively

The evaluation findings and recommendations would be reported to the client on completion of the project

Project Name: Feasibility study and project advisory services for formation of warehousing finance company

Year: August 2013 – Feb 2014

Location: New Delhi

Client: Central Warehousing Corporation, a Government of India undertaking

Main project features:

CWC is a leading warehousing agency in India established during 1957 providing logistics support to the agricultural sector. It is one of the biggest public warehouse operators in the country offering logistics services to a diverse group of clients

CWC is operating 464 Warehouses across the country with a storage capacity of 10.65 million tons and plays a major role in maintaining the food security of India.

The client envisages to enter into warehouse related financial services with an objective of promoting commodity warehousing practice within the farming community. A separate Non-Banking Finance Company (NBFC) will be created for rolling out of financial services such as Warehouse Receipt Based Finance, Finance for input material, working capital finance & warehousing infrastructure lending

PwC is mandated to carry out feasibility for the entry of CWC into financial services related to warehousing business. The study will include market analysis of warehousing finance business in India, regulatory framework study, structural and organizational analysis, capability assessment and define the risks and mitigation framework. As a result of the study, PwC will prepare a business plan for starting the NBFC business specifying business case for entering into financial services domain.

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed-Guidance in undertaking:

Conceptualizing and developing framework for project execution

Guiding the team in undertaking analysis of warehousing finance market size & segments, regulatory framework, market players & Competition, Risks involved in the business, demand & supply gap etc.

The assignment would involve following major activities -

Identifying opportunity and capability assessment:

- SWOT analysis for the proposed diversification
- Capability assessment & Identifying the business segments for CWC
- Matching the capabilities with the opportunities and - identifying the key products/ service features & Understanding the Biz. Synergies and fitments

Development of Business Plan

- Identify portfolio & monitoring mechanism
- Identify the marketing & staffing strategy
- Identify the capital requirement & institutional framework
- Organisation structure & Define the risks and the mitigation framework

Project Name: DPR Preparation for Integrated Large Scale Farming of Rice in Ghana

Year: May 2013 to Aug 2013

Location: Ghana

Client: Leading Rice Processor (confidential)

Main project features:

PwC was mandated to prepare bankable Detailed Project Report after evaluating the land parcels suitability for integrated large scale rice farming.

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed-Guidance in undertaking:

- Conceptualizing and developing framework for project execution
- Guiding the team in undertaking detailed assessment of the agronomic, social, economic and capital requirements of the project by interacting with various Government Bodies and service providers in Ghana
- Relationship manager for building linkages between client and the host country
- Assisting the client for overall negotiation with the land owners in the host country and established a Memorandum of Understanding between the supplier and buyer (client)
- Liaising officials at Ghana Embassy, Indian Embassy, & other stakeholders to develop way forward for initiating large scale corporate farming in Ghana

Project Name: Evaluation of Financial Impact of a farmer program on Soybean Farmers for a private sector company in India

Year: Nov 2012 to March 2013

Location: Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh, India

Client: A Multinational Agro chemical company

Main project features:

The client has an existing farmers' programme targeted towards **increasing the economic returns to farmers located in key Soybean growing areas of Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra states.** Under the program, company's crop protection team guides Soybean farmers on crop protection and non-crop protection interventions to enable them to grow more and better Soybean per unit area.

Over the years, company has been internally analyzing the increase in yield and profitability attributed to farmers' programme. The company appointed PwC as an external agency to evaluate the financial impact of farmers' programme on soybean growers.

PwC interviewed a sample of 600+ farmers in Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra and compared the farm practices, yield and profitability per hectare between suggested practices in sample plot and traditional farm practices as followed in control plot of each farmer. The assessment was done for crop performance during the year 2012.

In addition, PwC captured the felt needs of farmers with regard to soybean cultivation advisory (from seed to market) that were not currently covered by Farmers' Programme

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed-Guidance in undertaking:

- Conceptualized and developed framework for project execution
- Guided the team in undertaking identification of the baseline for evaluation in terms of crop profile, farmer profile and programme profile, assessment of impact of programme on crop profitability, identification of the felt needs of the farmer with regard to soybean cultivation advisory (from seed to market) that are not currently being covered by the Programme

Project Name: Identifying opportunities and entry into large scale corporate farming of rice in Africa

Year: Feb' 2013 to May 2013

Location: Pan Africa

Client: Leading Rice Processor

Main project features:

PwC was mandated to conduct a desk study to identify the best possible prospect meeting the requirements of large scale corporate farming and processing of rice in Africa. PwC had scanned the external / macro environment of Africa in terms of scope for agricultural production and political, social, economic, technological and regulatory environment of its various countries, specific to agriculture. Based on the environmental scan a **preliminary assessment of the opportunity** would be prepared wherein the **large**

scale rice cultivation with encouraging political and regulatory environment would be assessed to identify the most suitable country for entry into corporate farming of rice.

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed-Guidance in undertaking:

- Conceptualizing and developing framework for project execution
- Guiding the team in undertaking macro environmental scan –(to conduct an in-depth study of agriculture in the various countries in Africa and to study the regulatory environment of the various countries in the continent with respect to agriculture), development of opportunity matrix –(to assess the three countries found suitable in terms of encouraging political and regulatory environment to arrive at the best country to focus efforts on for entry into large scale corporate farming of rice) , identification of Suitable Pockets for Corporate Farming and comparative analysis
- The assignment involved pre-feasibility assessment – to study the Potential for establishing corporate farming systems, Indicative processing capacity, Indicative capital cost and operational cost of project, Indicative requirement of supporting infrastructure for project, Indicative revenue/business margins obtained and international competitiveness, Assessment of global and domestic market for major end product(s) in terms of Trade volumes/value Major production and consumption centres, Issues and challenges.

Project Name: Identification of location for Food Park in Africa and Detailed project report thereof

Year: June 2012 to Ongoing

Location: Pan Africa

Client: Ministry of Food Processing in India

Main project features:

PwC has been awarded the assignment of –

- Identifying the most suitable location for establishing the food park based on agricultural production strengths, potential investor interest, political stability, ease of doing business etc.
- Having identified the location develop a detailed project report which will form part of information memorandum that will be prepared by the implementing agency for attracting potential private investors

This project will be implemented in public private partnership mode with Govt. of India providing a subsidy of INR 500 million

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed-Guidance in undertaking:

- Conceptualizing and developing framework for project execution
- Guiding the team in undertaking identification of location suitable for food park industry

Project Name: Cotton Drip Finance Project – India – Pilot Stage

Year: June 2012 to Ongoing

Location: India

Client: IFC (IKEA in Consortium)

Main project features:

Consortium has decided to assist in the conversion of minimum 1 hectare of minimum 300 farmers to drip irrigation systems.

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed-Guidance in undertaking:

- **Structuring overall strategy for the project**
- Monitoring the progress of the project as per the agreed ToR
- Guiding the team on approach including primary survey, data analysis, stakeholder meetings and delivery of results
- Taking overall responsibility of the project deliverables.

Project Name: Development of Vision for Food Processing Industry for Madhya Pradesh State

Year: February 2013 – Aug 2014

Location: Madhya Pradesh

Client: Department of Horticulture, Madhya Pradesh

Main project features:

Madhya Pradesh is the central Indian State and is a major producer of Grains (Soybean, wheat) Vegetables (chilli, onions, and garlic), Fruits (orange, lemon, and mandarin), and dairy and meat products.

The project aims at developing a comprehensive vision and strategic plan for promoting the food processing sector of the state. The state wants to identify key segments having potential for development of processing industry

through private sector participation. Further, the client also wants to create an environment for facilitation of growth of the industry by streamlining its policy framework and providing support and services as required by the private sector players.

The project also looks at integrating various ongoing schemes and support programs driven by different government institutes.

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed-Guidance in undertaking:

Conceptualizing and developing framework for project execution

Guiding the team in **undertaking Value chain analysis in select agribusiness sub-sectors**, understanding existing situation in terms of production, trade, processing, infrastructure, credit requirement, financing arrangement and subsequent gap analysis.

The assignment would involve phased development plan for promotion of the food processing industry and bringing development through private sector participation.

Project Name: Small and Medium Enterprise (SME) Trade Finance Development Facility

Year: November 2012 - Ongoing

Location: All India

Client: Asian Development Bank

Main project features:

The project aims at assisting an Indian Commercial Bank to **design and implement SME cluster development study for effective penetration in the segment**. The project will involve detailed study for the lending environment, regulatory set up, competitor activity in the identified SME segments focused on specific value chains. The value chain analysis will **identify financing needs of global value chains originating from India**, identify gaps in value chains from operations and credit perspective and analyse policy and intervention for the bank in order to device financing plan for key value chains. The study will further include a market entry and business plan development for the identified value chains. It would further involve providing assistance in the roll out of business plan in selected SME clusters and training of the bank staff.

Position held: In-house SME specialist and team management

Activities performed-Guidance in undertaking:

- Conceptualizing and developing framework for undertaking SME cluster analysis.
- Guiding the team in undertaking **Value chain analysis** for the identified clusters, benchmarking with best practices, undertaking competitor activity and development of gap analysis.
- Development of new products suiting the current requirement of the SME segments.
- Guiding team in development of financing plan for the identified value chains and business plan development and subsequent roll out of the plan.
- Coordinating with the client and team on operationalizing the study.

Project Name: All India Outcome Focused Impact Evaluation of Sub-Projects under National Agricultural Innovation Project (NAIP)

Year: April 2012 – July 2014

Location: All India

Client: Project Implementation Unit (PIU), NAIP

Main project features: The study involves impact evaluation of 187 agricultural sub-projects under the NAIP framework. The project has four categories of sub-projects focused on the following:

1. Capacity Development of Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) for information, communication and dissemination capacities, business planning and development, skill development to strengthen the National Agricultural Research System (NARS)
2. To promote 'production to consumption systems research' in priority areas/ themes to enhance productivity, nutrition, profitability, income and employment
3. To improve livelihood security of rural people living in the selected disadvantaged regions through technology-led innovation systems, encompassing the wider process of social and economic change covering all stakeholders
4. To build capacity to undertake basic and strategic research in frontier areas to meet challenges in technology development in the immediate and predictable future

Position held: Quality Assurance and Guidance

Activities performed-Guidance in undertaking:

Mid Term impact evaluation of the sub-projects was undertaken. This also includes developing case studies of selected projects. The impact assessment includes:

- Evaluating efficiency and impact of the NAIP, in revitalizing the agricultural research system and

contributions in transforming Indian agriculture to a more market driven approach; and

- Implications of NAIP funded research and business processes for the agriculture sector in India on the following:
 - institutional development, including institutional pluralism for undertaking agricultural research, regional integration through consortia, etc.;
 - human resource development, infrastructure development and related aspects;
 - Improvement of the system's efficiency and their impact on enhancing its effectiveness, including setting up of Business Planning and Development Units, private sector and NGO participation, commercialization of technologies and improved uptake pathways for research outputs;
 - Efficiency, sustainability and equity impacts at the national sector and farm level
- Final Impact evaluation to be undertaken at the end of project

Project Name: Designing Access to Finance Program for Meghalaya State

Year: June 2012 – Dec 2012

Location: Meghalaya

Client: International Finance Corporation (IFC)

Main project features:

The project aims at developing workable solutions for improving access to finance in Meghalaya State. IFC wanted a comprehensive assessment of the institutional requirement, technology, sector services, etc. in the financial sector. PwC **designed implementation strategy to improve access to finance** covering key stakeholders (agricultural, institutional, urban users)

Position held: Agriculture/SME Expert

Activities performed: Provided expert opinion in

- **Assessment of agricultural situation** of Meghalaya with focus on private sector enterprises
- **Assessment of access to finance needs of the agricultural sector** and quantification of benefits to be availed from these services
- Working out applicability of suggested solution themes in the context of agricultural situation of the state
- Implementation roadmap plan to include key target beneficiaries and likely impact of the same

Project Name: Revamping of **Supply Chain Management** of Food Corporation of India (FCI)

Year: Feb 2012 –Feb 2013

Location: All India

Client: Food Corporation of India(FCI)

Main project features: The study involves through analysis of procurement, logistics, distribution of food grains across India by FCI with a special focus on the logistics issues faced with the Indian Railways and suggesting suitable modification to improvements in each of these systems.

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed:

- Analysis of food grain production in India and procurement of food grains by FCI
- Analysis of food grain movement planning process its constraints and related issues
- Analysis of grain storage and depot operations.
- Analysis of grain movement specially Rail Movement

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Project Name: Strategic Review of Tanzania Cotton Board (TCB)

Year: Feb 2012 – May 2012

Location: Tanzania

Client: Tanzania Gatsby Trust (TGT)

Main project features: The TCB is empowered with the role for regulating the cotton sector of Tanzania. Post liberalization of the sector, there has been a lot of issues being faced by the sector and the TCB. There needs to be a comprehensive study on TCB to align its role with the existing and future requirements of the local and global cotton sector through a turnaround strategy.

Position held: International Agriculture Expert

Activities performed:

- Evaluating exiting roles, structure and functions of TCB as a cotton sector regulator
- Benchmarking with similar crop boards, cotton boards
- Designing a framework for strengthening the role and functioning of TCB

- Structuring Organizational Development Plan for TCB

Project Name: Scoping Study on Climate Resilient Agriculture and Food Security Pilot Program for Climate Resilience (PPCR)

Year: Feb 2012 – Aug 2012

Location: Nepal

Client: International Finance Corporation (IFC), Washington

Main project features: IFC through the Pre-implementation phase of the project “Building resilience through pvt. sector participation” intends to undertake a comprehensive identification, profiling and assessment of the critical gaps of the current system across different stakeholders involved in agri-input, climate information and agri-finance. Further, based on the same, IFC intends to structure a roadmap/work plan for implementing improved climate resilient systems in agriculture through forging effective partnerships. Also through this project IFC intends to chart out its role for facilitating implementation of climate resilient systems. The end result of this study will be a Project Design Document which will serve as a precursor for a 5 year technical assistance project to be taken up in the Implementation phase.

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed:

- Detailed Mapping of different agricultural value chains in existing agro climatic zones of Nepal
- Identifying most vulnerable value chains and understanding the impact of climate change on them
- Devising early warning systems
- Developing a framework for implementation of PPCR, identifying partners for investment in Nepal

Project Name: Assessment of Financial Assistance Scheme (FAS) for Agricultural & Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA), Ministry of Commerce & Industries, Govt. Of India

Year: June 2011- Jan 2012

Location: New Delhi

Client: APEDA

Main project features: The project aims at appraising its Financial Assistance Schemes (FAS) for the last five year plan with an objective of improving the scheme structure, target beneficiaries and simplifying scheme structure for boosting exports of Agricultural Processed food.

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed:

- **Structuring overall strategy** for the project
- Monitoring the progress of the project as per the agreed ToR
- Guiding the team on approach including primary survey, data analysis, stakeholder meetings and delivery of results
- Taking overall responsibility of the project deliverables.

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Project Name: Cotton Drip Finance Project - India

Year: June 2011- Jan 2012

Location: New Delhi, Maharashtra, Gujarat and Punjab

Client: The Dutch Sustainable Trade Initiative (IDH), The Netherlands

Main project features: The project aims at understanding the **supply chain constraint of the cotton farmers in the context of usage of drip irrigation equipment for improving irrigation efficiency.**

The project also aims at analysing various other stakeholders in the cotton supply chain – input providers, NGO’s, Extension service providers, traders, ginners, retailers, micro irrigation equipment manufacturers, financial institutions etc. **to understand viability of scalable financing models for adoption of micro irrigation** by cotton farmers. The project is supported by International Finance Corporation (IFC), IKEA and C&A

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed:

- Structuring overall strategy for the project
- Monitoring the progress of the project as per the agreed ToR
- Guiding the team on approach including primary survey, data analysis, stakeholder meetings and delivery of results
- Taking overall responsibility of the project deliverables.

Project Name: Restructuring Organizational Structure for National Seed Corporation (NSC) for aligning it to adopt hybrid seed based business model.

Year: Aug 2011- Jan 2012

Location: New Delhi

Client: National Seed Corporation (NSC)

Main project features: NSC has traditionally been into the business of generic seeds. NSC now plans to promote the hybrid seed business for which it has mandated PwC to analyse the industry, bench mark with leading private players and suggest appropriate organizational structure for pursuing its hybrid seed business.

Position held: Seed Industry Specialist

Activities performed:

- Understanding the requirements of NSC
- Assisting the team in benchmarking NSC with private seed players

Project Name: Developing framework for effective project management for Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO), India.

Year: 2011- ongoing

Location: New Delhi

Client: FAO, India

Position held: Agriculture Expert

Main project features: FAO has been facing difficulty at different levels in project execution with its government counterparts in India. The project aims at identifying critical areas resulting in inefficient project execution and develop a recommended framework for an effective project execution.

Position held: Agricultural Specialist

Activities performed:

- Understanding the requirements of FAO and Government departments
- Evaluation of critical areas
- Assistance in developing framework for effective execution

At YES Bank Limited

Ajay was the head North India for Food and Agribusiness Strategic advisory team in YES BANK. He was also actively involved in designing financial solutions for key agribusiness clients with the Agri Micro Rural Banking (AMRB) group.

Lending Business: (2006-2011)

- Assisting Agri Micro & Rural Banking (AMRB) team in meeting Priority Sector Lending (PSL) targets by providing Agri sector overview, sector analysis and industry due diligence for Agro and food processing clients
- Assessing the potential for cluster financing of Agri SME clusters, designing and implementing cluster based financial products targeted at Agri SME segment
- Undertaking joint client handling for evaluation of high value SME clients for the purpose of Agri lending.
- Assistance in credit evaluation of high value SME for Priority sector Lending (PSL)
- Technical evaluation of target companies (SME's) along with the investment banking team for Merger and Acquisition (M&A) purposes.

Advisory Business (2006-2011) – Project

Project Name: Structuring Sector Strategy for Fruit & Vegetable and Dairy Sector for Ethiopia

Year: 2009-10

Location: Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

Client: United Nation Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO), Vienna, Austria

Main project features: Ethiopia has largest bovine population among west African countries, however its dairy sector is highly underdeveloped. Similarly the Fruits and vegetable sector is also underdeveloped despite good agro-climatic conditions that favours a large number of tropical and temperate fruits and vegetable.

UNIDO with Ministry of Trade and Commerce, Ethiopia wanted to device strategic plan for the dairy and F&V sector of Ethiopia particularly from the viewpoint of promoting exports and attracting investment in the sector.

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed:

- Structuring overall strategy for the project
- Monitoring the progress of the project as per the agreed ToR
- Guiding the team on approach including primary survey, data analysis, stakeholder meetings and delivery of results
- Taking overall responsibility of the project deliverables.

Project Name: Assessment of “Impact of Global Financial Crisis on Least Developed Countries a case study of Fruits & Vegetable Sector of Nepal & Bhutan”.

Year: 2009-10

Location: Nepal & Bhutan

Client: United Nation Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO), Vienna, Austria

Main project features: Nepal and Bhutan are small economies with high dependence on agricultural systems. UNIDO had undertaken study on a global level to understand impact of financial crisis of 2008 on the various sectors among weaker economies of the world. Nepal and Bhutan were selected for **analysing the impact of crisis on the F&V sector**. The study findings were posted on UNIDO website

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed:

- Structuring overall strategy for the project
- Monitoring the progress of the project as per the agreed ToR
- Guiding the team on approach including primary survey, data analysis, stakeholder meetings and delivery of results
- Taking overall responsibility of the project deliverables.

Project Name: Analysis of Shrimps and Prawn export from Bangladesh and assessment of feasibility of food testing lab for Shrimp and Prawn export.

Year: 2008-09

Location: Bangladesh

Client: United Nation Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO), Vienna, Austria

Main project features: UNIDO along with Ministry of Fisheries wanted a feasibility to be done on setting up of an additional food testing lab for Shrimps and Prawns in Bangladesh for facilitating the export of these products.

Position held: Project Leader

Activities performed:

- Structuring overall strategy for the project
- Monitoring the progress of the project as per the agreed ToR
- Guiding the team on approach including primary survey, data analysis, stakeholder meetings and delivery of results
- Taking overall responsibility of the project deliverables.

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Project Name: Value Chain Analysis of Farming Community in Maharashtra for developing sustainable livelihood solutions

Year: 2008-09

Location: Vidharbha region of Maharashtra, India

Client: United Nation Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO), India

Main project features: IFAD and UNIDO jointly took up the case of Vidharbha region of Maharashtra to investigate the livelihood options of farming community. This was triggered by high suicides and high indebtedness of the farmers in the region

The study investigated the value chain of cotton farmers, their livelihood options and suggested means of developing sustainable livelihood options apart from cotton.

Position held: Value Chain Expert

Activities performed:

- Analysis of Cotton **Value Chain**
- Understanding critical areas impacting the farming community

Project Name: Advising Cane and Bamboo Technology Centre (CBTC) Guwahati, Assam to design an effective pan India market entry strategy for bamboo products

Year: 2008-09

Location: Assam, India

Client: National Horticulture Mission, Cane and Bamboo Technology Centre, Assam, India

Main project features: CBTC is an organization which aims at promotion of cane and bamboo products across India. In spite of supply strength and technical skills among the bamboo product manufacturers, there was a huge gap in the marketing side of the bamboo products. The study aimed at understanding the existing situation in the marketing process of bamboo products. Also to identify the critical gaps in marketing strategy, trade issues, client service, market channels etc. to improve the marketing strength of these products.

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed:

- Structuring overall strategy for the project
- Monitoring the progress of the project as per the agreed ToR
- Guiding the team on approach including primary survey, data analysis, stakeholder meetings and delivery of results
- Taking overall responsibility of the project deliverables.

Project Name:

1. Preparation of **action plan for development of food processing industries** in Leh-Ladakh and Kargil regions of Jammu & Kashmir
2. Preparation of DPR and Project Implementation as PMC for establishing Mega Food Park under Mega Food Park Scheme
3. Preparation of Detailed Project Report (DPR) for establishment of cold chain infrastructure under the Cold chain scheme

Year: 2008-09, 2009-10

Location: India

Client: Ministry of Food Processing Industries and Ministry of Agriculture

Main project features:

1. The Ministry of Food Processing wanted to boost the food processing sector in Leh-Ladakh region of J&K. The project aimed at analysing the food processing sector of the region and devising feasible projects suiting the agro climatic and business need of the area.
2. Advised private player for developing Mega Food Park Project. Guided different clients from the EOI stage to the Master planning stage.
3. Advised different private players to apply for the cold chain infrastructure subsidy scheme

Position held: Team Leader for Leh-Ladakh, Cold Chain Infra project, Team member for Mega Food Park

Activities performed:

- Structuring overall strategy for the project
- Monitoring the progress of the project as per the agreed ToR
- Guiding the team on approach including primary survey, data analysis, stakeholder meetings and delivery of results
- Taking overall responsibility of the project deliverables.

Project Name:

Development of masterplan blue-print for **setting up the IFFCO Kisan SEZ – an Agri-based processing zone**. Done along with Wageningen University, Netherlands.

Year: 2008-10

Location: Nellore, Andhra Pradesh

Client: IFFCO Kisan SEZ

Main project features: The project involved development of a procurement and logistics plan for agricultural produce that would be needed by processing units envisaged to be set up in IFFCO Kisan SEZ, Nellore.

Positions held: Team member

Activities performed: Scanning of Nellore and surrounding districts of Andhra Pradesh to identify production centers of key agricultural produce including fruits and vegetables, identifying locations to set up Rural Transformation Centres (RTCs) to be used as procurement centres, Developing a viable logistics and distribution to link Farmers – RTCs – Agro Park – Distribution Centres (at Consumption Centres). The project also involved a detailed supply chain analysis and mapping of process flows for procurement, handling, storage and transportation of agricultural produce – including F&V, poultry, fish and milk.

Project Name: Mega Food Park

Year: 2009

Location: Punjab, India

Client: Private Sector Client

Main project features: The client was awarded Mega Food Park project by the Ministry of Food Processing and Industries Limited (MoFPI). The project involves the private player to develop masterplan for undertaking Food Processing activity in the earmarked area. The project was supported by MoFPI through subsidy.

Position held: Team Member

Activities performed:

- Assessment of land parcel for development of food park
- Logistic and business feasibility of different locations for developing food park
- Developing front end and back end linkages for the client for successfully taking up the food processing activity.
- Developing business masterplan including infrastructure layout for developing the food park.
- Assisting the client in all activities related to development of food park DPR.

Project Name: Mega Food Park

Year: 2011

Location: Karnataka, India

Client: Private Sector Client

Main project features: The client was awarded Mega Food Park project by the Ministry of Food Processing and Industries Limited (MoFPI). The project involves the private player to **develop masterplan for undertaking Food Processing activity in the earmarked area**. The project was supported by MoFPI through subsidy.

Position held: Team Member

Activities performed:

- Assessment of land parcel for development of food park
- Logistic and business feasibility of different locations for developing food park
- Developing front end and back end linkages for the client for successfully taking up the food processing activity.
- Developing business masterplan including infrastructure layout for developing the food park.
- Assisting the client in all activities related to development of food park DPR including detailed financial analysis and phase wise infrastructure development plan.
- Developing the implementation plan for the client and getting the same approved from MoFPI

Project Name: Cold Chain Development – Three separate assignments

Year: 2010

Location: Punjab, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu India

Client: Private Sector Client

Main project features: Two Separate client's wanted to apply with MoFPI for Subsidy under Cold Chain Development Scheme.

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed:

- Led the team for development of Cold Chain Project for Fruits and Vegetables and Dairy Sector
- Supervised the DPR preparation for each project
- Assisting in undertaking bank appraisal and securing debt for the proposed project.
- Scouting for Technical and financial partner for the consortium and assisting in formation of the SPV
- Securing backward and forward linkages for the proposed Cold Chain project

Project Name: Modern Terminal Market (MTM)

Year: 2006--09

Location: India

Client: Ministry of Agriculture and various State Governments

Main project features: Conceptualizing structural framework for Modern Terminal Market (MTM) Project to improve productivity through technical and operational integration of the entire value chain of perishable agricultural produce in India

Undertook DPR preparation for various MTM's at state level (Nagaland, Chandigarh, Orissa, Mumbai)

Position held: Team Leader

Activities performed:

- Structuring overall strategy for the project
- Monitoring the progress of the project as per the agreed ToR
- Guiding the team on approach including primary survey, data analysis, stakeholder meetings and delivery of results
- Taking overall responsibility of the project deliverables.
- Conceptualizing **structural framework for Modern Terminal Market (MTM) Project to improve productivity through technical and operational integration of the entire value chain of perishable agricultural produce in India**